

1 "How come"

- It's a grammatical shortcut that English adopted because it's efficient and carries a specific conversational nuance.
- **"How come" questions don't require subject-verb inversion.**
 - Normal Question (with inversion):** "Why **are you** so dirty?"
 - "How Come" Question (no inversion): "How come **you are** so dirty?"
(Same word order as the statement: "You are so dirty.")
 - Reason: "How come" is a shortened, colloquial form of "How did it come about that..." or "How comes it that...". Over time, the phrase got shortened and fossilized into the fixed expression.
 - * "How come you are so dirty?"
 - * "How did it come about that you are so dirty?"
 - inversion happens in the first clause ("How did it come...").
- **Differences from "Why":**
 - Inversion:
 - * "Why": with inversion (unless the subject is a question word itself).
 - Why **is she** late?
 - * "How come": no inversion.
 - How come **she is** late?
 - Usage/Tone:
 - * "How come":
 - more informal
 - often shows surprise, skepticism, or a request for an explanation that the speaker finds puzzling